

Andrew Primmer, PhD

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Aston Business School, Aston University

RESEARCH AREAS

Accounting Choice and Political Risk; Financial Reporting and Disclosure; Reserve Accounting; Narrative Disclosure; Counterfactual Financial Modelling; Accounting, Race and Colonialism; Accounting and Imperialism; Accounting History; Business History.

APPOINTMENTS

Sept 2026- **Teaching Fellow (VAP), Accounting, Aston Business School, Aston University**

Feb. 2025 – **Research Associate, Accounting History, University of Bristol**
Present

Oct. 2020 – **British Academy Postdoctoral Fellow, Accounting History, University of Reading**
Feb. 2025

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Accounting, University of Portsmouth

Thesis Title: *Accounting as Imperial Governance: Financial Reporting, Disclosure, and Legitimacy in British, Belgian and Portuguese Overseas Enterprise, c. 1890–1940*

Ph.D. in Business (*History minor*), University of Bristol

Thesis Title: *‘Capital, Monopoly and Economic Nationalism: A History of British Railways in Colombia*

Maestria in History, Universidad Nacional de Colombia

4.6/5.0 GPA - Highest mark in Cohort

BA (Hons) in History, University of Wales, Swansea

PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (ACCA), UK — Part-Qualified

PRACTICE EXPERIENCE IN ACCOUNTING

2019-2020	Dyson, Malmesbury UK. (British Multinational)
2018, 2021	IVC Evidensia, Bristol, UK. (European Multinational)
2013-2015	Snap-on, Reading, UK. (US Multinational)
2009-2011	Fiserv, Wokingham UK. (US Multinational)
2006-2008	Defra – Rural Payments Agency (Public Sector)

AWARDS, HONORS, RECOGNITIONS

2020	British Academy Postdoctoral Fellowship (£270,000)
2015	Deas Fellowship, Department of History, University of Bristol (£40,000)
2014	Santander Travel Grant, University of Bristol (£3,000)
2011	Beca de estudiante sobresaliente, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, (£20,000)

PUBLICATIONS AND SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Published Articles

2026. (forthcoming). Profiting from the Wage Gap: Accounting, Race, and Extraction in the Northern Rhodesian Copperbelt, 1931–39, *Accounting History*.

2026. (forthcoming). Excavating Global Capitalism: Internalisation, Hub-Based Processing, and British Silver Mining in Colombia, 1824–1899, *Enterprise and Society*.

Forthcoming. Accounting for Political Risk: Reserve Structures and Capital Portability in British Railways in Colombia, 1904–1929, *Accounting Historians Journal*.

2025. Finding El Dorado: The rise and fall of the Jenks business group in Colombia 1899-1929, *Business History Review*.

<https://doi.org/10.1017/S0007680525100810>

2025. Mismanagement amid Resource Abundance: Sovereign Risk, Private Sector Credit Rationing, and Economic Stagnation in Colombia, 1861-1898, *The Economic History Review*.

<https://doi.org/10.1111/ehr.13414>

2024. “Market Failure, Information Asymmetries and Monopoly Profits: The Barranquilla Railway and Pier Company in Colombia, 1888-1933”, *Enterprise & Society*, DOI:

<https://doi.org/10.1017/eso.2024.18>

2023. “British overseas railway investment and economic development: The Colombian National Railway Company and its impact on the Colombian interior”, *Business History*,

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/00076791.2020.1844665>

2021. “Railway Nationalism And «Railway Imperialism» In Colombia and The Economic Decline of Santander, 1907–1918”, *Revista de Historia Economica - Journal of Iberian and Latin American*

Economic History, DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0212610919000399>

Work in Progress

In Review. Looking through the Balance Sheet: Value Relevance, Dividend Restriction, and Colonial Railway Debt, 1905–1926, *British Accounting Review* (with Martin Persson, University of Illinois Champaign-Urbana).

WIP. Taxing an Indivisible Railway: Administrative Allocation Across Five Jurisdictions in Southern Africa, 1926–1946, preparing for submission to *Journal of Tax Administration*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2023-2025	MM309: Business Evolution
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- Provided lecture on international business in the global south
- Delivered seminars on advanced financial statement analysis (ratio analysis, cash flows, earnings quality, valuation).
- Designed case-based learning using real corporate financial statements across industries.

2023-2025 **MMM095, Multinational Enterprise Strategy and Performance (Financial Statement Analysis and Business Strategy), Henley Business School, University of Reading**

- Facilitated weekly workshops on business, international business, and strategy using case-based discussion.
- Guided students in applying theoretical frameworks to real-world business problems.
- Provided structured feedback on presentations to develop analytical reasoning and communication skills.
- Fostered peer learning through debate and collaborative discussion.

2023-2025 **MM1F19 Management Debates: Ways of Thinking About Business, International Business and Strategy, Henley Business School, University of Reading**

- Facilitated weekly workshops on business, international business, and strategy using case-based discussion.
- Guided students in applying theoretical frameworks to real-world business problems.
- Provided structured feedback on presentations to develop analytical reasoning and communication skills.
- Fostered peer learning through debate and collaborative discussion

2023-2025 **MM296 Building Competitive Advantage: Business Strategy and Operations, International Business and Strategy, Henley Business School, University of Reading**

- Delivered weekly seminars on competitive strategy, operations, and organizational performance.
- Led discussions on core frameworks (Porter, RBV, value chains) and their practical application.
- Used real-world cases to link operational decisions to strategic outcomes.
- Supported student skill development through feedback on presentations and group projects.

2021-2025 **Course Convenor, EC243 Economic History, Department of Economics, University of Reading**

- Designed and convened a full undergraduate module, including lectures, seminars, assessments, and online materials.
- Delivered lectures on capitalism, industrialisation, global trade, and the evolution of capital markets.
- Developed source-based seminars linking historical analysis to contemporary economic and business issues.
- Supervised student research projects and provided detailed feedback on essays and exams.

2019-2020 **Senior Associate Teacher, Department of Hispanic and Latin American Studies, University of Bristol**

Courses taught:

Critical Concepts in the Study of the Hispanic World

- Delivered lectures and seminars on colonial legacies, nationalism, and cultural identity.
- Used interdisciplinary approaches combining history, politics, and cultural analysis.
- Developed students' critical reading, discussion, and analytical writing skills.

2015-2018 Teaching Assistant, History Department, University of Bristol

Courses taught:**Introduction to the British Empire**

- Led seminar discussions on imperial expansion, colonial governance, and postcolonial legacies.
- Encouraged engagement with historiographical debates and primary sources.
- Provided tailored feedback on essays and exam preparation.

2011 – 2013 Course Convenor and Assistant Professor, Britain and Colombia 1820-1930, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Bogotá

- Designed and delivered a full upper-level undergraduate course, including syllabus, materials, and assessments.
- Taught methodology classes on primary source analysis and archival research.
- Integrated English-language sources to support historical analysis and language development.
- Mentored students through research projects and written assignments.

2021-2025 Course Convenor, EC243 Economic History, Department of Economics, University of Reading

- Designed and convened a full undergraduate module, including lectures, seminars, assessments, and online materials.
- Delivered lectures on capitalism, industrialisation, global trade, and the evolution of capital markets.
- Developed source-based seminars linking historical analysis to contemporary economic and business issues.
- Supervised student research projects and provided detailed feedback on essays and exams.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PAPERS

2026. Profiting from the Wage Gap: Accounting, Race, and Extraction in the Northern Rhodesian Copperbelt, 1931–39, BAFA - British Accounting and Finance Association, Aston University, Birmingham, UK

2026. Excavating Global Capitalism: Internalisation, Hub-Based Processing, and British Silver Mining in Colombia, 1824–1899, Business History Conference, Imperial College, London, UK

2026. Profiting from the Wage Gap: Accounting, Race, and Extraction in the Northern Rhodesian Copperbelt, 1931–39, Economic History Society, LSE, London, UK

2025. Profiting from the Wage Gap: Accounting, Race, and Extraction in the Northern Rhodesian Copperbelt, 1931–39, AAA – American Accounting Association Annual Conference, Chicago, USA (accepted but not presented due to travel complications)

2024. Quantifying Imperialism: Roan Antelope Copper Mines Ltd and the Economic Impact of Imperialism in Central Africa, 1927-1939, Association of Business Historians, York, UK

2024. Accounting for “Railway Imperialism”: The Beira Railway Act of 1914, *Accounting History Review Conference*, Southport, UK.

2024. “Railway Imperialism” in South Central Africa: The Beira Railway Company and Colonial Expansion in Southern Africa”, *The Business History Conference (Enterprise and Society)*, Providence, USA.

2019. “A Profile of a 'Gentlemanly Capitalist': Shirley Jenks's Business Interests in Colombia”, The Business History Conference (Enterprise and Society), Mexico City (Led to article in R&R with Business History Review)

2019. ““British Overseas Investment Reconsidered: A fresh perspective from a Colombian case study”, *Accounting History Review Conference*, Edge Hill University, UK

2018. “The Colombian National Railway Company: Political Stability and Company Profitability A Case Study” (New Researcher Paper), Economic History Society Annual Conference (Economic History Review), Keele University (Led to publication in *Business History*)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIP

Referee	Enterprise and Society, Business History, Bulletin of Latin American Research
Member	American Accounting Association
	BAFA
	Economic History Society
	Association of Business Historians
	Business History Conference

LANGUAGES

English	Native Speaker
Spanish	Native Level Competency
Portuguese	Advanced reading comprehension

SOFTWARE SKILLS

Python, Stata, Excel, AI

REFEREES

Prof. Cheryl McWatters

Department of Accounting

Assistant Professor . Martin Persson

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